

S $\Delta\phi$ -21 — Judgment as Intuition Authority Assignment: Minimal Axioms for Editable Decisions after No-Exit Intuition (v1.0)

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Core thesis: Judgment is the operation that assigns authority to intuition markers (I), and collapse occurs when that authority becomes non-editable.

S $\Delta\phi$ -20 defined intuition (I) as the trace-marker of no-exit compression basins. This paper defines judgment (J) as the minimal operation that assigns authority to such intuition markers to produce decisions. The central risk is over-authority: when authority becomes non-editable, the system drifts into closure. The central failure on the other side is under-authority: when no intuition marker is granted stable priority, the system fragments into drift.

Scope: minimal axioms, diagnostic regimes, and editability conditions. The goal is not a psychological theory of “decision-making” but a structural account of how decision authority becomes irreversible, and how openness can be stabilized without collapse.

Keywords: judgment, authority assignment, intuition marker, editability, closure, drift, no-exit constraint, $\Delta\phi$, openness stabilization.

1. Problem

Once intuition is understood as an irreversible compression trace ($S\Delta\phi$ -20), the next question is inevitable: when does an intuition marker become authoritative? Systems do not act on all intuitions equally. They assign priority, prohibit alternatives, and lock in routes. That authority assignment is what we call judgment.

Question: What is the minimal structure that turns intuition (I) into a decision, while keeping the decision space editable?

2. Minimal Definitions

Term	Definition
I (Intuition marker)	A trace-dominant basin signal: “search is no longer worth it here” ($S\Delta\phi$ -20).
A (Authority)	A priority weight or gating rule assigned to an intuition marker, determining which r
J (Judgment)	The operation $J: I \rightarrow A(I)$, i.e., authority assignment over intuition markers.
Editability (E^d)	The ability to revise $A(I)$ under new evidence/constraints without runaway cost.
Authority debt (DA)	Accumulated cost of misassigned authority that increases revision resistance over t
Closure	A regime where $A(I)$ becomes non-editable; alternatives become computationally in
Drift	A regime where authority fails to stabilize; decisions fragment and consistency colla

3. Minimal Axioms

A1 (Intuition plurality). Any bounded system generates multiple intuition markers $I_1 \dots I_n$ across competing basins.

A2 (Authority assignment). Judgment assigns authority A to a subset of intuition markers, producing an executable route.

A3 (Irreversibility threshold). If revision cost exceeds the update budget, authority becomes effectively irreversible.

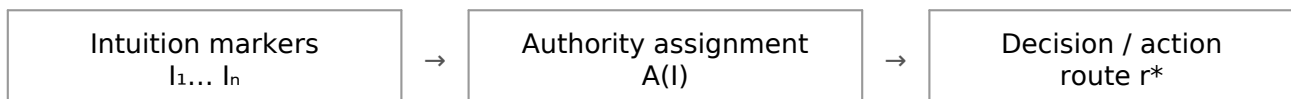
A4 (Two failure modes). Over-authority yields closure; under-authority yields drift.

A5 (Open persistence). Sustained openness requires periodic authority re-editing triggered by conflict, error, or external perturbation.

Note. These axioms are substrate-agnostic. They apply to individual cognition, organizations, and AI systems as long as (i) multiple basins exist and (ii) authority can become costly to revise.

4. Mechanism: Intuition $\rightarrow$ Authority $\rightarrow$ Decision (IAD) Loop

Judgment is modeled as an authority gate layered on top of intuition. The loop below shows how authority assignment becomes self-reinforcing (authority debt) unless editability is actively maintained.





Authority debt DA
(revision resistance)



Re-entry: next state
biased by r^*

5. Diagnostic Regimes: Drift, Closure, and Editable Judgment

Judgment regimes can be diagnosed by how authority is assigned and revised. This triad parallels earlier $S\Delta\phi$ diagnostics (closure vs openness stabilization).

Regime	Authority pattern	Observable signature	Structural risk
Under-authority (Drift)	A(I) unstable or absent	Over-search; inconsistency; delayed commitments	Fragmentation, incoherence
Over-authority (Closure)	A(I) rigid; revision cost high	High commitment; resistance to change	No exit, self-locking
Editable judgment (Openness)	A(I) stable, revisable	Commit + revise; conflict used	Sustained progress

6. Minimal Conditions for Editability

Editability is not “openness” as an attitude. It is a structural property: authority must remain revisable at finite cost. Minimal conditions:

C1 (Conflict intake). The system must allow perturbations that challenge A(I) (external or internal).

C2 (Marker separation). Authority A(I) must be distinguishable from intuition I (no identity collapse).

C3 (Revision budget). There must exist an update budget that can actually pay the revision cost.

C4 (Rollback handle). The system must retain at least a minimal handle to alternative routes (not fully pruned).

C5 (Maintenance mode). Periodic maintenance (cf. $S\Delta\phi$ -19) to prevent runaway authority debt.

7. Series Position and References

$S\Delta\phi$ -21 continues $S\Delta\phi$ -20 by specifying the minimal step from intuition to action: authority assignment. It interfaces directly with closure ($S\Delta\phi$ -16) and openness stabilization ($S\Delta\phi$ -17), and it assumes maintenance modes ($S\Delta\phi$ -19). It also aligns with $H_{\min}$ ($S\Delta\phi$ -07) by treating authority as a re-entry marker rather than a final truth claim.

Series references (DOI):

$S\Delta\phi$ -03 — Irreversibility as the Minimal Condition of Existence (v1.1) —

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18730448>

$S\Delta\phi$ -07 — $H_{\min}$ Interpretation: Minimal Axioms (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18735006>

$S\Delta\phi$ -16 — Evil as Relational Closure: Minimal Failure Modes (v1.0) —

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18763262>

$S\Delta\phi$ -17 — Openness Stabilization: Path Principles... (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18763581>

$S\Delta\phi$ -19 — Consciousness and Sleep as $\Delta\phi$ Maintenance Modes (v1.0) —

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18776311>

$S\Delta\phi$ -20 — Intuition as Irreversible Compression Trace: No-Exit Convergence (v1.0) —

<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18787647>

8. Closing Questions

If judgment is authority assignment over intuition markers, then the central governance question shifts: who or what controls authority revision triggers? A system may remain open not by “believing in openness,” but by preserving editability under finite cost.

Exit question: Under what conditions does a system treat its own authority assignments as non-negotiable, and what minimal perturbations keep authority revisable without collapsing into drift?